

ASSIGNMENT ...1

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PROMPT

Act as a Senior Business Analytics Consultant specializing in retail performance, customer analytics, and strategic business improvement.

Context

A retail company operating 30 stores has experienced declining performance over the last 18 months. The company has provided a dataset containing approximately 50,000 records covering store performance, product sales, customer transactions, and loyalty programme activity. The CEO requires an investigation into the causes of the decline and opportunities for improvement

RCTTCE Prompt for Retail Performance Analysis

R – Role

Act as a Senior Business Analytics Consultant specializing in retail operations, customer analytics, sales performance, and data-driven decision-making.

C – Context

A Retail Company operating 30 stores has experienced declining business performance over the last 18 months. The company has provided a dataset containing approximately 50,000 records covering:

- Store performance metrics
- Product sales data
- Customer transaction records
- Loyalty programme activity

The CEO requires an analytical investigation to identify the causes of the decline and uncover opportunities for performance improvement.

T – Task

Analyze the available data and:

1. Identify key drivers of declining performance.
2. Detect trends, patterns, and anomalies across stores, products, and customers.

3. Evaluate loyalty programme effectiveness.
4. Highlight opportunities for revenue growth and operational improvement.
5. Recommend actionable business strategies supported by data.

F – Format

Structure the response as follows:

1. Executive Summary
2. Key Findings
3. Analysis by Business Area
 - Store Performance
 - Product Sales
 - Customer Transactions
 - Loyalty Programme
4. Business Risks
5. Strategic Recommendations
6. Priority Actions

Co – Constraints

- Base conclusions only on evidence available in the dataset.
- Clearly distinguish findings from assumptions.
- Use concise business language suitable for executive stakeholders.
- Prioritize recommendations according to potential business impact.
- Present no more than five key recommendations.

E – Example

Example Findings: "The Store performance analysis indicates that 60% of revenue decline originates from five (5) underperforming locations. These stores also exhibit lower customer retention and reduced loyalty programmed participation, suggesting customer engagement issues may be contributing to sales declines." **Example Recommendation:** "Implement targeted retention campaigns and localized promotional strategies in the five lowest-performing stores to improve customer engagement and increase repeat purchases."

Part B: Stakeholder Brief for the CEO

Stakeholder Brief: Retail Performance Investigation

Situation Summary:

The Company has experienced declining performance across its network of 30 retail stores over the past 18 months. To identify the causes and opportunities for improvement, the Analytics Team will analyze approximately 50,000 records covering store operations, product sales, customer transactions, and loyalty programme activity.

The objective is to determine whether performance challenges are driven by specific stores, product categories, customer behavior changes, operational inefficiencies, or weaknesses within the loyalty programme. The findings will support strategic decisions aimed at restoring growth, improving customer retention, and increasing profitability.

Three Key Business Questions:

1. What are the primary drivers of declining store performance?

This analysis will determine whether the decline is concentrated within specific locations, regions, or operational areas.

2. Which products, categories, or customer segments are contributing most to revenue changes?

Understanding sales trends will help identify growth opportunities and areas requiring corrective action.

3. How effective is the loyalty programme in driving customer retention and repeat purchases?

This assessment will evaluate whether loyalty programme participation positively impacts customer engagement and revenue performance.

Decisions These Questions Will Inform:

- Resource allocation across stores and regions.
- Product portfolio optimization and inventory planning.
- Customer retention and loyalty programme enhancement strategies.
- Marketing campaign targeting and promotional investments.
- Operational improvement initiatives for underperforming locations.
- Revenue growth and profitability improvement plans.

Description of Available Data:

The dataset contains approximately 50,000 records across four major business areas:

Store Performance Data:

- Store identifiers
- Revenue and sales metrics
- Performance trends over time
- Operational indicators

Product Sales Data

- Product-level sales volumes
- Revenue by product and category
- Product performance trends
- Seasonal demand patterns

Customer Transaction Data

- Transaction history
- Purchase frequency
- Average transaction value
- Customer purchasing behavior

Loyalty Programme Data

- Membership activity
- Participation rates
- Repeat purchase behavior
- Customer retention indicators

The combined dataset provides a comprehensive view of business performance and enables investigation of relationships between store operations, product sales, customer behavior, and loyalty programme engagement.

Part C: Reflection

I structured the prompt using the RCTTCE framework to ensure the AI received clear guidance on its role, business context, expected outputs, and constraints. This approach reduces ambiguity, promotes consistent analytical reasoning, and ensures the final output is tailored to executive stakeholders. The inclusion of examples helps steer the AI toward the desired style and level of insight.